



Let's Play With CodeIgniter

Part—2

In the previous article in this series, we discussed the concept of the MVC structure used in CodeIgniter, did a 'Hello world' program, and a simple program with database connectivity. Now, let's take a look at different form APIs, built-in validations, and pagination techniques.



Note: I got many readers writing in to say the database part (the last program in Part 1) was not working. In most cases, I found that people skipped the configuration part of the article, and directly jumped to the program part. I request all readers to configure CodeIgniter properly before using it. Without following the configuration steps outlined in the previous part, you won't be able to use the APIs of this great framework.

Form APIs

Well, to use form APIs, you must include the 'form' in the autoload helpers in your *autoload.php* configuration file, such as: `$autoload['helper'] = array('url','form');`



Note: You always need to include helpers in the *autoload* file to access their APIs. For example: If you want to include file uploads in your application, you must include 'file' in *autoload* helper.

Let's create a simple login form, and add form validation rules. We created the 'lfy_users' database table with the *username* and *password* columns. I manually added an entry; you can also do this by creating a separate form. Our form is simple to look at; you can add CSS if you want. There will be three files in the MVC structure:

1. Controller File: *login.php* (/var/www/ci2/application/controllers/login.php)
2. View File: *loginview.php* (/var/www/ci2/application/views/loginview.php)
3. Model File: *loginmodel.php* (/var/www/ci2/application/models/loginmodel.php)

The loginview.php file

```
<html>
<head>
<title>Login View </title>
</head>
<body>
```